

Fenner Dunlop Americas, v. Nantz

Heavy-duty conveyor-belt engineering, including carcass construction, rubber compounds, splicing, diagnostics, monitoring, and belt-system performance for mining and bulk-material handling.

Independent preliminary research based on public information.

FILED	FORUM	DOCKET	MATTER
2026-08-21	W.D. Pa.	2:26-cv-01762	Trade Secret

Prepared 2026-08-25. No attorney or expert contacted. Availability, interest, compensation, and conflicts not checked.

Public filing, likely recipient, and technical frame

CAPTION	Fenner Dunlop Americas, LLC v. Nantz et al.
FORUM / DOCKET	W.D. Pa. / 2:26-cv-01762
FILED / TYPE	2026-08-21 / trade secret
PUBLIC DOCKET	Open docket

VERIFIED PUBLIC RECORD

Fenner Dunlop Americas, LLC v. Nantz et al., No. 2:26-cv-01762, filed 2026-08-21 in W.D. Pa..

LIKELY RESEARCH PURCHASER

Gregory H. Wagoner - Shumaker, Loop & Kendrick, LLP; named matter counsel. The public docket lists Wagoner as plaintiff counsel; the complaint was filed for Fenner Dunlop and his firm biography specifically identifies trade-secret protection, restrictive-covenant disputes, and emergency relief as part of his practice.

gwagoner@shumaker.com - publicly listed on the [official firm biography](#); not inferred.

TECHNICAL FRAME

Heavy-duty conveyor-belt engineering, including carcass construction, rubber compounds, splicing, diagnostics, monitoring, and belt-system performance for mining and bulk-material handling.

Secondary-source limitation: This is a preliminary technical frame based on public sources. Filed pleadings, claim charts, discovery, source code, product versions, and admissible evidence must control. [Open public synopsis](#)

Questions likely to require expert input

This issue map is a research plan, not a legal conclusion. The filed complaint, patent exhibits, intrinsic record, and discovery must control.

01 What belt carcass, cover-compound, splice, monitoring, and performance know-how was actually maintained as secret?

What belt carcass, cover-compound, splice, monitoring, and performance know-how was actually maintained as secret?

Potential evidence: Pleadings and claim charts; source code or engineering records; product and version documentation; standards and prior art; reproducible testing; and fact or technical testimony as applicable.

02 Could a qualified conveyor engineer derive the alleged information from public standards, vendor literature, inspection, or routine testing?

Could a qualified conveyor engineer derive the alleged information from public standards, vendor literature, inspection, or routine testing?

Potential evidence: Pleadings and claim charts; source code or engineering records; product and version documentation; standards and prior art; reproducible testing; and fact or technical testimony as applicable.

03 Which belt failures, diagnostics, or customer-system data embody the alleged know-how, and what technical value do they provide?

Which belt failures, diagnostics, or customer-system data embody the alleged know-how, and what technical value do they provide?

Potential evidence: Pleadings and claim charts; source code or engineering records; product and version documentation; standards and prior art; reproducible testing; and fact or technical testimony as applicable.

Questions likely to require expert input

Candidates 1-2 for further diligence

Ranked for preliminary research priority based on subject-matter fit, relevant public work, testimony, and visible diligence burden. This is not a retention recommendation.

01 Gabriel Lodewijks

President, Conveyor Experts BV; former professor of transport engineering and logistics

TECHNICAL FIT

Direct belt-conveyor dynamics, automation, material handling, and system-design fit.

RELEVANT WORK

PhD on belt-system dynamics; author of belt-conveyor research and longtime conveyor-technology professor.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Current academic appointment is not established by the cited source; consulting role heightens conflict and compensation diligence.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | g.lodewijks@conveyor-experts.com | [public email source](#)

02 Yusong Pang

Assistant professor/researcher in transport engineering and logistics, Delft University of Technology

TECHNICAL FIT

Direct fit for conveyor monitoring, control, automation, and condition diagnostics.

RELEVANT WORK

PhD research in belt-conveyor monitoring and control; coauthor on conveyor flywheel/dynamics work.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

European location and an older contact publication require role confirmation before retention.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | y.pang@tudelft.nl | [public email source](#)

Candidates 3-4 for further diligence

03 Johannes Fottner

Professor and chair of Materials Handling, Material Flow and Logistics, Technical University of Munich

TECHNICAL FIT

Strong fit for bulk-material conveying architecture, drives, logistics, and machinery performance.

RELEVANT WORK

Leads TUM's materials-handling and material-flow chair and publishes on conveying/logistics systems.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Broad materials-handling remit is less specific to rubber belt carcass chemistry.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | j.fottner@tum.de | [public email source](#)

04 Micah Nehring

Senior Lecturer, School of Mechanical and Mining Engineering, University of Queensland

TECHNICAL FIT

Strong mining-system fit for in-pit crusher-conveyor planning and operating performance.

RELEVANT WORK

Leads research on IPCC systems, mine planning, scheduling, and installation.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Focus is mine-system planning rather than belt compounding, splicing, or laboratory failure analysis.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | m.nehring@uq.edu.au | [public email source](#)

Candidates 5-6 for further diligence

05 James Busfield

Professor of Materials and head of the Soft Matter Group, Queen Mary University of London

TECHNICAL FIT

Strong rubber/elastomer fit for abrasion, fatigue, creep, fracture, reinforcement, and aging of belt covers.

RELEVANT WORK

Publishes on physical behavior and modeling of rubbers and elastomers; editorial work in Rubber Chemistry and Technology.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Not a conveyor-system designer; strongest on material-condition and failure questions.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | j.busfield@qmul.ac.uk | [public email source](#)

06 Ben Jar

Professor of Mechanical Engineering, University of Alberta

TECHNICAL FIT

Strong fit for polymer/composite deformation, fracture, test-method design, and survivability.

RELEVANT WORK

Develops material-evaluation methods and models deformation/failure of polymers and composites.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

No conveyor-specific publication was located; may require a companion conveying specialist.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | ben.jar@ualberta.ca | [public email source](#)

Candidates 7-8 for further diligence

07 Gerard Fernando

Professor of Polymer Engineering, University of Birmingham

TECHNICAL FIT

Fit for polymer/composite process monitoring, structural-integrity sensing, and belt-condition diagnostics.

RELEVANT WORK

Heads a sensors and composites group; works on fiber-optic process monitoring and structural integrity.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Research profile is broader than conveyor belts and mining operations.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | g.fernando@bham.ac.uk | [public email source](#)

08 Mark D. Soucek

Sundar L. Aggarwal Endowed Professor, University of Akron School of Polymer Science and Polymer Engineering

TECHNICAL FIT

Fit for polymer formulation, coatings, cure, and chemical/material characterization relevant to belt compounds.

RELEVANT WORK

Senior polymer-engineering faculty member with extensive coatings and polymer-materials research.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

No direct conveyor-belt or mining-system work is identified on the cited faculty directory.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | msoucek@uakron.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 9-10 for further diligence

09 Shi-Qing Wang

Kumho Distinguished Professor, University of Akron School of Polymer Science and Polymer Engineering

TECHNICAL FIT

Fit for polymer rheology, deformation, fracture, and structure-property interpretation of belt rubber.

RELEVANT WORK

Distinguished polymer scientist with a large body of work on polymer dynamics and mechanical response.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Academic polymer focus; practical belt splicing and field diagnostics are not established.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | swang@uakron.edu | [public email source](#)

10 Sadhan C. Jana

BFGoodrich Professor, University of Akron School of Polymer Science and Polymer Engineering

TECHNICAL FIT

Fit for polymer composites, fillers, processing, and rubber-compound structure/property issues.

RELEVANT WORK

Longstanding polymer-engineering research and BFGoodrich professorship connect directly to industrial polymer materials.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial testimony was located in the bounded public-source review.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Conveyor-specific design and maintenance experience is not shown in the cited public source.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | janas@uakron.edu | [public email source](#)

Preliminary candidates; no conflicts or availability determination

- Run party, affiliate, counsel, inventor, funder, and technology conflicts.
- Confirm testimony history, exclusions, compensation, publications, patents, and deposition performance.
- Investigate licensing, grants, consulting, commercial interests, and prior technical positions.
- Confirm role fit, availability, and interest only after counsel authorizes outreach.

ONGOING MATTER-SPECIFIC RESEARCH

Flint Witness Research works in the post-filing window, turning pleadings and public technical records into issue maps, researched candidate slates, and diligence starting points as the case develops.

[Schedule a 15-minute conversation](#)

CORE SOURCES

Public docket: <https://dockets.justia.com/docket/pennsylvania/pawdce/2%3A2026cv01762/334959>

Official attorney biography and email: <https://www.shumaker.com/wp-content/themes/jrd-shumaker/inc/generate-bio-pdf.php?who=5481>

Public technical context source: <https://fennerdunlopamericas.com/>

LIMITATIONS

This is a preliminary technical frame based on public sources. Filed pleadings, claim charts, discovery, source code, product versions, and admissible evidence must control.

No attorney or expert was contacted. Availability, interest, compensation, and conflicts were not checked.